Khrushchev's positive response to President Kennedy's official offer. That was certainly how Robert Kennedy understood the purpose of his meeting with Dobrynin.

Before parting ways with the ambassador, Kennedy asked him to keep the Turkish part of the deal secret. "Especially so that the correspondents don't find out," he told Dobrynin, according to the latter's report to Moscow. "At our place for the time being even [Pierre] Salinger does not know about it." Dobrynin assured him that he was the only person in the entire embassy who had the information. Robert left, telling Dobrynin that he would finally be able to see his children, as he had been "entirely absent from home."[8]

"It was quite a different meeting from the night before," wrote Robert Kennedy in his memoir. He remembered going back to the White House to brief the president on his meeting with Dobrynin.[9]

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ROBERT KENNEDY ARRIVED IN THE OVAL OFFICE AS HIS brother placed calls to three of his predecessors—Herbert Hoover, Harry Truman, and Dwight Eisenhower. He was calling to report the victory and lie about the way it was achieved. All he relied on were the assurances given by Dobrynin that the Soviets would keep silent about the Turkish missiles.

John Kennedy placed his first telephone call to the predecessor who mattered most to him, General Eisenhower. "General, how are you?" began Kennedy before going into details of his exchange of messages with Khrushchev. He reminded Eisenhower that Khrushchev had issued a public message agreeing to remove the missiles from Cuba "if we withdrew our missiles from Turkey." Kennedy continued: "We then, as you know, issued a statement that we couldn't get into that deal. So we then got this message this morning." "But Mr. President, did he put any conditions … ?" asked Eisenhower. The president responded with a lie: "No, except that we're not going to invade Cuba." To Eisenhower's "Yes," Kennedy continued in the same vein: "That's the only one that we've got now."[10]